Suicide Note(s) – A Collection

By Ellen Hopkins, Ebukun Gbemisola Ogunyemi, Janice Mirikitani, and Daisy Bojorquez

Impulse by Ellen Hopkins
(excerpts from a novel written in verse)

Wish

You could turn off
The questions, turn
Off the voices,
Turn off all sound

Yearn

To close out
The ugliness, close
Out the filthiness,
Close out all light.

Long

To cast away
Yesterday, cast
Away memory,

4NG Fanatics

Cast away all jeopardy.

Pray

You could somehow stop
The uncertainty, somehow
Stop the loathing,
Somehow stop the pain

INTRODUCTION

Talking about suicide is difficult . . . I get it. But according to experts, what we say or don't say, and how we say it, makes a difference. Our words matter to those struggling with thoughts of ending their own lives and to those reeling from the loss caused by suicide. Regardless of race, gender, or culture . . . silence makes matters worse and that's why it's time to talk about . . . .

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The first cut
Wasn't the deepest.
No, not at all.
It was like the others,
A subtle rend of anxious skin,

A gentle pulse of crimson,
Just enough to hush the demons
Shrieking inside my brain
But this time they wouldn't
Shut up. Just kept on
Howling, like mama,
When she was in a bad way.
Worst thing was, the older
I got, the more I began to see
How much I resembled mama
Falling in and out of the blue,
Then lifting up into the white
That day I actually
Thought about howling
So I gave myself to the knife,
Asked it to bite a little
Harder, chew a little deeper.
The hot, scarlet rush
Felt so delicious
I couldn't stop there.
The blade might have reached

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Bone, but my little
Brother, Bryan
Barged into the bathroom,
Found me leaning against
Grandma's new porcelain
Tub, turning its unstained
White pink.
You should
Have heard
Him scream.

I hate this feeling
Like I'm here, but I'm not.
Like someone cares.
But they don't.
Like I belong somewhere
Else, anywhere but here,
And escape lies just past
That snowy window,
Cool and crisp as the February
Air. I consider the streets

Beyond, bleak as the bleached

Bones of wilderness

Scaffolding my heart.

Just a stone's throw away.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ellen Hopkins
Book: Impulse
ISBN: 978-1416903574
Publisher: McElderry Books
Date (Month/Year): Jan 2007

AWARD HISTORY

Selections from this novel in verse received the following awards:

2008 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifeir

Ebukun's Suicide Note by Ebukun Gbemisola Ogunyemi (Better known at Ibukunwrites)

. . . A Nigerian storyteller and creative writer, she writes to shed light, bring light, hope and restoration. . .

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This is the suicide note

I never wrote on days when I

Tried taking my own life but chickened out.

This is the exhaustion I couldn't put into words

because I had absolutely nothing to pour

too stressed to write

I just wanted to leave

No one wants you when you're here but

everyone suddenly wants you to stay when you're gone

I told myself

I had no loved one to write to

Whatever they made of my demise, I could care less

but I guess I was mad

I was mad about the love I constantly sought but

never got.

But isn't this life

Isn't my life worth more than a protest?

Isn't this life given to me for a reason?

Isn't this life mine and no one else's for a reason?

Yes, I thought as much.

The reason I have to fight this hard is because

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I have the ability to survive
so today and every other day, I'll choose to stay
this space is mine, this space belongs to me
so I just don't get to walk away
So today and every other day
I'll choose to stay, I'll chose to fight
I'll resist the urge to die and fight one last time
until there are no wars – no wars to be fought.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ebukun Gbemisola Ogunyemi
Book: The Lost Poets: Suicide Notes
ISBN: 978-1799078135
Publisher: Independently Published
Date (Month/Year): March 7, 2019

Suicide Note by Janice Mirikitani

. . . An Asian American college student was reported to have jumped to her death from her dormitory window. Her body was found two days later under a deep cover of snow. Her suicide note contained an apology to her parents for having received less than a perfect four point grade average. . .

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How many notes written. . .
ink smeared like birdprints in snow.
not good enough
not pretty enough
not smart enough
dear mother and father.
I apologize
for disappointing you.

I've worked very hard,
not good enough
harder, perhaps to please you.
If only I were a son, shoulders broad
as the sunset threading through pine,
I would see the light in my mother's
eyes, or the golden pride reflected
in my father's dream
of my wide, male hands worthy of work
and comfort.
I would swagger through life
muscled and bold and assured,

drawing praises to me
like currents in the bed of wind, virile
with confidence
not good enough
not strong enough
not good enough
I apologize.
Tasks do not come easily.
Each failure, a glacier.
Each disapproval, a bootprint.
Each disappointment,
ice above my river.
So I have worked hard.
not good enough
My sacrifice I will drop
bone by bone, perched
on the ledge of my womanhood,
fragile as wings.
not strong enough
It is snowing steadily
surely not good weather

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for flying—this sparrow
sullied and dizzied by the wind
on the edge.
not smart enough
I make this ledge my altar
to offer penance.
This air will not hold me,
the snow burdens my crippled wings,
the tears drop like bitter cloth
softly into the gutter below.
not good enough
not strong enough
not smart enough
Choices thin as shaved
ice. Notes shredded
drift like snow
on my broken body,
covers me like whispers
of sorries
sorries.
Perhaps when they find me

they will bury

my bird bones beneath

a sturdy pine

and scatter my feathers like

unspoken song

over this white and cold and silent

breast of earth.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Janice Mirikitani
Book: The Oxford Book of Women's Writing in the United States
ISBN: 978-0195132458
Publisher: Oxford University Press
Date (Month/Year): 1999

AWARD HISTORY

KS State Qualifier

Daisy's Suicide Note by Daisy Bojorquez

. . . Despite having a mental illness and a difficult life, she was able to survive and is now an artist and poet living in Southern California. This poem was written to comfort those in need and to help them hang on for one more day. .

EDUCATIONAL

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Finally,

I just wanted the pain to stop.

But . . .

Did I really just do this?

Oh my God . . .

Wait . . .

My life is passing by my eyes.

I see my parent's faces.

I see my best friend's face.

I see the face of my love.

Wait . . .

Now I see them crying.

Sobbing.

I see them blaming themselves.

All of a sudden I don't know if I want this . . .

This was supposed to be release for me . . . for them . . .

I thought I was just a heavy burden . . .

No one complete understood.

The pain and the sadness that engulfed me each day . . .

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But they still loved me.

My live continues to leave me. . .

Oh my God I was wrong . . .

What did I . . . . . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Daisy Bojorquez
Book: The Lost Poets: Suicide Notes
ISBN: 978-1799078135
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